

CART 498 A1 - Short Reflection

Sam Hoyek | 25 September 2026 | 255 words

I was trying to make something that feels digitally surreal, combining glitch effects with reality and making it look like the glitch is actually in the scene rather than imposed on the image in post-processing. The Z-Image process failed at delivering that, but ChatGPT did a much better job of grasping the concept and delivering something good. ChatGPT integrated the computer-type glitches into the images as though they were actually being photographed and were happening in the space that was photographed, whereas Z-Image just added what looks like post-processing to photos that don't have those anomalies within them.

The carwash study used one saved prompt with three seeds to test variations on the same scene. The Z-Image seeds were slight variations that were better or worse. They felt like multiple generations you were supposed to pick one of, rather than meaningful variations that could form a series.

I think AI for artists opens up the process of iteration and going through different ideas, building a massive body of choice really quickly. This can be a process of curation and deliberate selection that feels like going down a path or hacking away in a jungle to make your own by iterating, discarding, compiling, and generating based on chosen and rejected output, pushing it further until you arrive at something uniquely weird and uncanny.

Arca's *Riquiquí;Bronze-Instances(1-100)* uses Bronze to make 100 variations of one track. I like the iterative nature and copied variation nature of Arca's project, and I'm a big fan of Arca's work in general.

Work cited. Arca, *Riquiquí;Bronze-Instances(1-100)* (XL Recordings, 2020). [Official release](#); [Bronze project description](#).

AI-use note. Sam Hoyek supplied the reflective content. Codex assisted with light formatting, factual identification of the named work, and PDF production.